Outlook

Fw: NEW outpatient ORTHO process/referral for HRMC, PBH, VH ONLY

Sending on behalf of the Medical Directors

For HRMC, PBH, VH ONLY - This process can be started today

Situation

Patients discharged from the Emergency Department with orthopedic injuries are experiencing delays in outpatient orthopedic follow-up and in some cases are being lost to follow-up entirely.

Background

Prior to the Epic transition, an outpatient orthopedic follow-up list was generated from ED discharge patients. Orthopedic offices used this list to proactively contact patients and arrange follow-up appointments.

Currently, this automatic patient capture process is not occurring, which has led to delays in care and missed follow-up opportunities for patients with orthopedic injuries.

Assessment

Without a standardized referral process from the ED, outpatient orthopedic services do not receive a consolidated list of patients requiring follow-up. As a result:

- Patients may not know how to schedule follow-up
- Orthopedic clinics cannot proactively contact patients
- Follow-up care is delayed, potentially impacting outcomes

Recommendation

When discharging patients from HRMC, VH, or PBH who require outpatient orthopedic follow-up, ED providers should place the Epic order:

"Ambulatory Referral to Orthopedic Surgery" - favorite this for ease of future use.

Placing this order will:

- Capture the patient in the orthopedic outpatient referral workflow
- Allow Heath First orthopedic outpatient clinic(s) to identify patients needing follow-up
- Enable staff to contact patients directly to arrange appointments

Please refer to the Epic screenshot below demonstrating how to place this order. YOU DO NOT NEED TO INPUT A SPECIFIC PROVIDER, SO CAN LEAVE BLANK.

For DC instructions: IF patient wants to call, they can call central scheduling @ 321-434-3131. I called this myself and walked through the process, it was very simple. Patient presses #1 to make a new appointment and then they speak with a real person at that time and get appointment based on reported ortho injury and location they were seen at.

Ambulatory referral to Orthopedic Surgery

Accept | Cancel

Class: Incoming Referral | Internal Referral | Outgoing Referral

Referral: ☐ Override Restrictions

To Department Specialty: Orthopaedic Surgery | Orthopaedic Surgery

To Department:

To Provider Specialty: Orthopaedic Surgery | Orthopaedic Surgery | Pediatric Orthopaedic Surgery

To Provider:

What is the reason for visit?

Elbow | Foot & Ankle | Hip Replacement | Ortho Knee | Knee Replacement | Shoulder | Shoulder Replacement | Sports Medicine | Hand & Wrist

My clinical question is:

Priority: Routine | STAT

Referral Type: Consultation | Consultation

Comments: Insert SmartText 100%

Scheduling Instructions: Insert SmartText 100%

Check-out Comments: Insert SmartText 100%

Next Required | Accept | Cancel

Patient Estimate

Place orders

New Discharge Orders

Ambulatory referral to Orthopedic Surgery

Internal Referral, Orthopaedic Surgery, Orthopaedic Surgery

Select a pharmacy

Remove All